

Content Marketing & Strategy

Plan, create and share content that builds trust, brings customers and grows a brand in Mauritius

Avinesh Bundhoo & Fareez Fawdar · Oreegami Mauritius · October 2026



Content calendar · 8 weeks

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Educate		Reel		Offer		
	Story		Blog		Live	
Reel		Tips		UGC		
	Email		Reel			Recap

Inside this guide

- 1 What content marketing is
- 2 Content across the journey
- 3 The Mauritian landscape
- 4 What is changing in 2026
- 5 Goals and objectives
- 6 Know your audience
- 7 Content and competitor audit
- 8 Positioning and voice
- 9 Content pillars
- 10 Types and formats
- 11 Getting the mix right
- 12 Storytelling
- 13 Copywriting
- 14 Writing for the web
- 15 Visuals with Canva
- 16 Short-form video
- 17 Using AI responsibly
- 18 Repurposing
- 19 The editorial calendar
- 20 Workflow and production
- 21 Distribution
- 22 Platform playbooks
- 23 Creators, UGC, community
- 24 Content, SEO and AI answers
- 25 KPIs by goal
- 26 Analyse and improve
- 27 Legal and ethics
- 28 Case study: 8 weeks
- 29 Exercises and deliverable
- 30 Checklists and glossary

PART A

Foundations

What content marketing is,
how it works and what is
changing in 2026

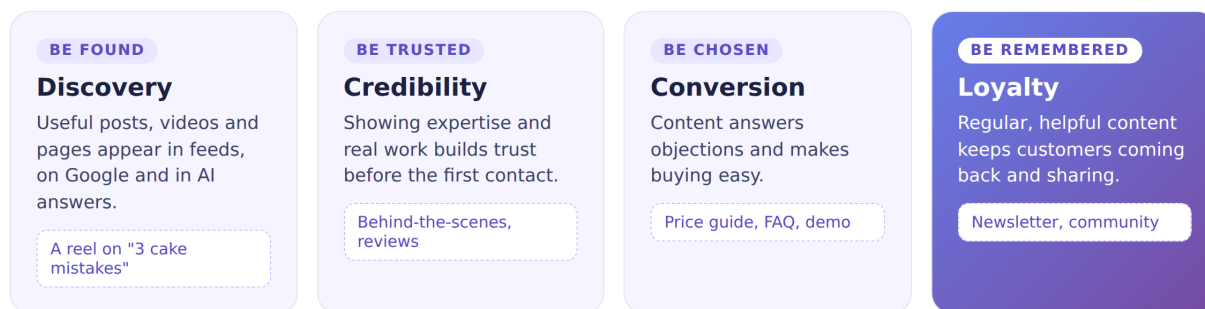
SECTION 1

What content marketing is

Content marketing means creating and sharing useful, interesting or entertaining material, such as posts, videos, articles, guides, emails and podcasts, so that the right people discover your business, trust it and eventually buy from it. Instead of interrupting people with an ad, you give them something they actually want.

Advertising rents attention. Content earns it.

What content marketing does for a business



Content marketing vs advertising

	Advertising	Content marketing
Main idea	Pay to put a message in front of people	Earn attention by being useful or entertaining
Message	"Buy from us"	"Here is how to solve your problem" (and we can help)
Speed	Immediate	Builds over weeks and months
When you stop paying	Results stop	Good content keeps working (search, shares, saves)
Trust	People know it is an ad	Builds credibility and expertise
Best for	Offers, launches, fast results	Long-term demand, trust, lower ad costs

The two work best together. Good content makes your ads cheaper and more convincing (people already know you), and ads can give your best content a push. In Weeks 6 to 9 you will learn paid media; this week builds the content that those ads will promote.

What counts as "content"?

- **Social posts:** photos, carousels, reels, stories, TikToks, LinkedIn posts, live videos.
- **Website content:** blog articles, guides, FAQ pages, product and service pages, case studies.
- **Video:** YouTube videos, tutorials, testimonials, behind-the-scenes, webinars.
- **Email and messaging:** newsletters, WhatsApp Channel updates, broadcast messages.
- **Downloadables:** checklists, price guides, e-books, templates, menus.
- **Audio:** podcasts, voice notes, audio guides.
- **Community content:** customer photos and reviews (user-generated content, or UGC), polls, Q&A sessions.

Why it matters for businesses in Mauritius

- **A small, connected market where reputation travels fast.** About 886,000 social media user identities (around 70% of the population) means word of mouth now happens online. Helpful content gets shared in family WhatsApp groups and Facebook groups.
- **Ad costs keep rising.** Businesses that publish useful content regularly need less ad budget to be noticed, because people already know and trust them.
- **Customers research before they buy**, even for local services: they look at your posts, reviews and website before calling.
- **Search and AI answers reward helpful content.** Week 3 showed that Google, AI Overviews and ChatGPT build their answers from pages that explain things clearly.
- **It builds an asset you own:** a library of content, an email list and a community that stay with you even when platforms change their rules.

In Mauritius: most local businesses post only promotions ("Special offer!", "New stock!") or nothing at all. A business that regularly answers customers' questions, shows its people and shares local know-how stands out immediately, even with a small budget.

The three promises of good content

Promise	Question to ask before publishing	Example
Useful	Will my customer learn or solve something?	"How much does a wedding photographer cost in Mauritius? A 2026 price guide"
Interesting	Will they stop scrolling and watch or read?	A 20-second time-lapse of a 3-tier cake being built
Relevant	Does it connect to what we sell and to who we serve?	A gym in Quatre Bornes sharing "5 exercises for beginners", not celebrity news

SECTION 2

How content works across the customer journey

In Week 1 you met the customer journey: awareness, consideration, conversion and loyalty. Each stage has different questions, so each needs different content. A common mistake is to publish only "buy now" content, which speaks to the small number of people who are ready today and ignores everyone else.

Content for every stage of the journey

Different questions at each stage need different content



Matching content to each stage

Stage	What people think	Content that helps	Typical KPI
Awareness	"I want to celebrate", "My back hurts", "We need a new website"	Short videos, tips, how-to posts, trends, guides, PR stories	Reach, views, new followers
Consideration	"Who can help? What are my options?"	Comparisons, case studies, FAQs, price guides, demos, live Q&A	Engagement, saves, website visits, time on page
Conversion	"Can I trust them? How do I order?"	Reviews, testimonials, offers, clear booking steps, guarantees	Leads, WhatsApp clicks, bookings, sales
Loyalty	"I'm a customer. What else?"	Thank-you emails, care tips, members' offers, community posts	Repeat purchases, referrals, reviews
Advocacy	"I recommend them."	Share-worthy moments, referral rewards, reposting customers' content	Shares, UGC, mentions

A simple rule of thumb

For most small businesses, a good starting balance is **about 60-70% of content for awareness and consideration** (helpful, entertaining, educational) and **30-40% for conversion and loyalty** (offers, reviews, calls to action). If you only sell, people stop listening; if you never sell, nobody knows what you offer.

Tip: look at your last 20 posts and label each one: awareness, consideration, conversion or loyalty. Most businesses discover that 80% are offers. That is the first thing this week's strategy will fix.

Search intent and content

People also arrive with different intentions on Google (Week 3): **know** (learn something), **go** (find a place or brand), **local** (near me) and **do/buy**. "Know" searches are where helpful content shines: a guesthouse that publishes "How to get from the airport to Trou aux Biches" reaches travellers weeks before they book.

SECTION 3

The content landscape in Mauritius

Before planning, understand where your audience spends time, which languages they use and what moments matter in the local calendar.

Where people are

Platform	Reach in Mauritius	What works there
Facebook	886,000 (about 70% of the population, +5.3% in a year)	Community, events, groups, local news, video, offers for 30+ audiences
Messenger / WhatsApp	Messenger 599,000; WhatsApp used by almost everyone with a smartphone	Conversations, orders, customer service, WhatsApp Channels and Status
LinkedIn	630,000 members (+16.7% in a year)	B2B, recruitment, training, expertise, personal brands
Instagram	418,000 (33% of the population, +9.2%)	Visual brands, food, fashion, beauty, tourism, younger audiences
YouTube	Widely used for tutorials, music and entertainment	How-to, reviews, long videos; Shorts for reach
TikTok	Popular with under-35s; strong discovery engine	Entertaining short video, trends, behind-the-scenes
X (Twitter)	210,000 ad reach	News and commentary; niche for most local brands
Google	About 92% of searches	Website pages, guides, FAQs, Google Business Profile posts

Sources: DataReportal Digital 2026 Mauritius (advertising reach estimates, not active users); Statcounter. TikTok and YouTube don't publish comparable local reach figures, so check your own audience data.

Language: write the way your customers speak

- **English** is expected on websites, for tourism and for B2B, and works well on LinkedIn.
- **French** is strong for local consumers, media and many Facebook audiences.
- **Kreol** creates closeness and humour in videos, stories, comments and WhatsApp. It shows you are local.
- Many successful local pages mix languages naturally (a French caption with a Kreol punchline, English subtitles on a video). Choose a main language per channel and stay consistent.
- For tourism, add the languages of your markets (French, English, German, Italian) where it matters.

The Mauritian content calendar

Moments that matter give you ready-made content ideas. Plan them weeks ahead, because competitors will post too.

Period	Key moments	Content ideas
January – February	New Year, school rentrée, Chinese Spring Festival, Thaipoosam Cavadee	Back-to-school lists, new-year goals, festival greetings and recipes
February – April	Maha Shivaratri, Independence Day (12 March), Ougadi	National pride, local products, "made in Mauritius" stories

Period	Key moments	Content ideas
March – May	Eid (date varies), Labour Day, Fête des Mères (end of May)	Gift guides, family stories, special menus
June – August	Winter season, Father's Day, school holidays (July–August)	Winter comfort, indoor activities, family offers
September – November	Ganesh Chaturthi, Divali, end-of-year events, wedding season	Recipes, decoration, gifts, wedding inspiration
December	Christmas, summer holidays, New Year's Eve, Black Friday (late Nov)	Gift guides, party ideas, holiday opening hours, year review
Tourism peaks	European winter (Nov–Apr), Réunion and South African holidays	Travel guides, experiences, multilingual content

Tip: festival dates change every year (lunar calendars). Check the official list of public holidays published by the Government of Mauritius each year before you plan.

What local audiences respond to

- **Real faces and places:** the team, the shop, a recognisable street or beach beats stock photos.
- **Humour and local references,** used respectfully.
- **Practical value:** prices, delivery areas, opening hours, "how to" content.
- **Community and family:** celebrations, local causes, customers' stories.
- **Respect for diversity:** Mauritius celebrates many cultures and religions. Greet every community's festivals with the same care, and check cultural details before posting.

SECTION 4

What is changing in 2026

Content marketing keeps evolving with platforms, search engines and AI. These are the shifts that matter most for a beginner planning content today.

Trend	What it means	What to do
AI everywhere	Most marketers now use AI tools to produce content. In CMI's research on 2026 trends, about 9 in 10 B2B marketers use AI to create content, but fewer than 4 in 10 say it improved performance.	Use AI for speed (ideas, drafts, variations), but add real expertise, local facts and your own photos. Quality and originality are what stand out.
Originality is rewarded	Instagram announced in 2026 that it favours original photos and videos over reposts. Google's systems favour helpful, people-first content.	Shoot your own content. If you use a trend or a template, add your own twist, information or humour.
Short video dominates discovery	Reels, TikTok and Shorts are the main way new audiences find brands. Instagram Reels of up to 3 minutes can now be recommended.	Plan at least one short video a week. Start simple: a phone, natural light, subtitles.
Shares and saves matter most	Platforms look at whether people send your post to friends or save it, not just likes.	Create content people want to send: useful lists, relatable situations, local tips.
Search goes social and AI	People search on TikTok, YouTube and Instagram, and ask ChatGPT or Gemini for recommendations.	Use clear keywords in captions and titles; answer real questions (Week 3, AEO and GEO).

Trend	What it means	What to do
Community and messaging	Conversations move to WhatsApp, private groups and DMs.	Use WhatsApp Channels and broadcast lists; reply fast; build a community, not just an audience.
Creators and employees	People trust people more than logos.	Feature your team, work with local creators, encourage customers to share.

The bottom line: tools change every year, but the fundamentals don't. Know your audience, be genuinely useful, be consistent, and measure what works. That is what this guide teaches.

PART B

Strategy

Goals, audience, voice,
pillars and the right mix

SECTION 5

From business goals to content goals

A content strategy is a plan that explains **why** you create content, **for whom**, **what** you will publish, **where** and **how often**, and **how** you will know it works. Without it, content becomes random posting that takes time and brings little.

The one-page content strategy

Question	Your answer covers
1. Why?	The business goal content supports (sales, leads, bookings, awareness, recruitment)
2. For whom?	One or two priority audiences (personas) and their questions
3. What makes us different?	Positioning and brand voice
4. What will we talk about?	3-5 content pillars
5. In which formats and where?	Formats and channels per pillar (distribution plan)
6. How often and who does it?	Calendar, cadence, roles and workflow
7. How do we measure success?	KPIs per goal and a monthly review

Turn business goals into SMART content objectives

In Week 1 you learned SMART objectives (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound). Apply them to content:

Business goal	Weak content goal	SMART content objective
More cake orders	"Post more on Instagram"	Generate 60 WhatsApp order enquiries a month from Instagram and Facebook content by the end of March
Fill the gym in the morning	"Be more visible"	Reach 25,000 people in Quatre Bornes and Rose Hill and get 40 trial-class sign-ups per month within 8 weeks
Win B2B clients for an accounting firm	"Do LinkedIn"	Publish 2 expert posts a week and 1 guide a month to get 10 qualified consultation requests per quarter
More direct bookings for a guesthouse	"Get more likes"	Increase direct-booking website sessions from content by 30% and email sign-ups to 300 by the end of the season

Tip: one main goal per quarter is enough for a small business. Content that tries to do everything at once usually does nothing well.

Choose your content KPIs early

Decide now how you will measure each objective (Section 25 explains the metrics): reach and views for awareness, engagement and saves for interest, clicks and enquiries for leads, and sales or bookings for revenue.

SECTION 6

Know your audience

You cannot create useful content for "everyone". The more precisely you know who you are talking to, what they worry about and which questions they ask, the easier it becomes to know what to publish.

Build a simple persona

A persona is a short profile of a typical customer, based on real conversations and data, not imagination. Two or three personas are enough.

Persona field	Example: "Busy Priya"
Who	Woman, 34, accountant, lives in Vacoas, married, two children
Goal	Organise beautiful family celebrations without stress
Problems and fears	No time, worried about quality and delivery on time, budget-conscious
Questions she asks	"How many people does a 2 kg cake feed?", "Can you deliver to Vacoas on Sunday?", "Eggless options?"
Where she spends time	Facebook and Instagram in the evening, WhatsApp all day, Google when planning
Content she likes	Short videos, ideas for parties, honest prices, reviews from other mothers
What makes her buy	Clear prices, real photos, fast WhatsApp replies, recommendations from friends
Language	French and Kreol for social; English is fine on the website

Where to find real audience insights (free)

- **Your customers:** the questions they ask on WhatsApp, Messenger, by phone and in the shop. Keep a list. Every question is a content idea.
- **Reviews:** your own and competitors' reviews on Google, Facebook and Tripadvisor show what people love and complain about.
- **Platform insights:** Meta Business Suite and LinkedIn analytics show age, gender, location and active times of your audience.
- **Google:** autocomplete, "People also ask" and Search Console (Week 3) show what people search.
- **GA4:** which pages and sources bring engaged visitors (Week 2).
- **Facebook groups and forums:** local groups about parenting, weddings, food or business are full of real questions.
- **Quick surveys:** an Instagram story poll or a 3-question Google Form with a small thank-you.

Jobs to be done: why people really buy

A useful question: **what "job" is the customer hiring your product for?** Nobody buys a cake just for flour and sugar; they buy a happy moment and the pride of a beautiful table. Someone joining a gym may be "hiring" confidence before a wedding. Content that speaks to the job (the outcome and the feeling) works better than content that only describes features.

Exercise (10 min): write 20 questions customers ask before they buy from you. Group them by stage of the journey. You now have 20 content ideas.

SECTION 7

Audit your content and your competitors

Before creating new content, look at what you already have and what others in your market are doing. An audit avoids repeating mistakes and reveals gaps you can fill.

Audit your own content

1. **List your channels:** website, Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube, Google Business Profile, email, WhatsApp.
2. **Collect the last 3 months of posts** (Meta Business Suite exports this) with reach, engagement, saves, shares and clicks.
3. **Tag each post:** topic, format (photo, carousel, reel, text), stage of the journey and whether it was an offer.
4. **Find patterns:** which topics and formats performed best? Which got no reaction?
5. **Check consistency:** same logo, bio, contact details and tone everywhere? Up-to-date opening hours and prices?
6. **Decide:** keep what works, improve what has potential, stop what doesn't help.

Analyse 3-5 competitors

What to look at	Questions to ask
Channels	Where are they active? Where are they absent (an opportunity for you)?
Frequency	How often do they post? Are they consistent?
Topics and pillars	What do they talk about? What questions are they not answering?
Formats	Reels, carousels, live, blog, email? Which get the most engagement?
Tone and visuals	Formal or friendly? Professional photos or phone videos? Recognisable style?
Engagement	Do people comment, share, tag friends? Does the brand reply?
Offers and CTAs	How do they ask people to buy or contact them?

Tip: the Meta Ad Library (facebook.com/ads/library) is free and shows all the ads a page is currently running, including in Mauritius. It is a great source of insight into competitors' messages and offers.

Look beyond your competitors

Also study brands in your sector abroad and the best local pages in other sectors. A Mauritian bakery can learn from a successful bakery in Paris or Cape Town, and from how a local telecom or bank uses humour and community.

Summarise in a simple SWOT

Strengths	Weaknesses
What we do well (e.g. great product photos, loyal customers)	What holds us back (e.g. irregular posting, no website content)
Opportunities	Threats
Gaps in the market (e.g. nobody explains prices; no one posts in Kreol)	Risks (e.g. new competitor with big ad budget, algorithm changes)

SECTION 8

Positioning and brand voice

People should recognise your content even without seeing your logo. That comes from a clear position (what you stand for) and a consistent voice (how you speak).

A one-sentence positioning statement

Use this template: **For** [audience] **who** [need], **we are** [brand/category] **that** [key benefit], **unlike** [alternative], **because** [proof].

For busy families in the centre of Mauritius who want beautiful celebration cakes without stress, Lakaz Gato is the neighbourhood cake studio that designs, bakes and delivers on time, unlike supermarket cakes, because every cake is made to order by our own pastry team with local ingredients.

Define your brand voice

Choose 3–4 personality traits and describe what each means in practice. A "this, not that" table keeps everyone consistent, including AI tools when you give them instructions.

Trait	We are...	We are not...	Example
Warm	Friendly, like a neighbour	Over-familiar or slangy everywhere	"Your party, our pleasure!"
Expert	Clear and helpful, we explain why	Technical or show-off	"Fresh cream needs 2–3 hours in the fridge before cutting."
Local	Proud of Mauritius, uses Kreol naturally	Cliché postcard Mauritius	"Gato pou tou fami, depi Rose Hill."
Honest	Clear about prices and limits	Vague or exaggerated	"Prices from Rs 1,800 for 1 kg. Orders 48 h ahead."

Tone changes, voice stays

Your **voice** is your personality and stays the same. Your **tone** adapts to the situation: playful on TikTok, more professional on LinkedIn, calm and caring when replying to a complaint.

Visual identity

- **Colours and fonts:** 2–3 brand colours and 1–2 fonts, saved in a Canva Brand Kit.
- **Logo use:** small and consistent (a corner, an end screen), never covering the content.
- **Photo style:** natural light? bright and colourful? close-ups? Decide and repeat.
- **Templates:** a few recognisable layouts for tips, quotes, offers and reviews.
- **Accessibility:** enough contrast, readable font sizes, subtitles on videos, alt text for images.

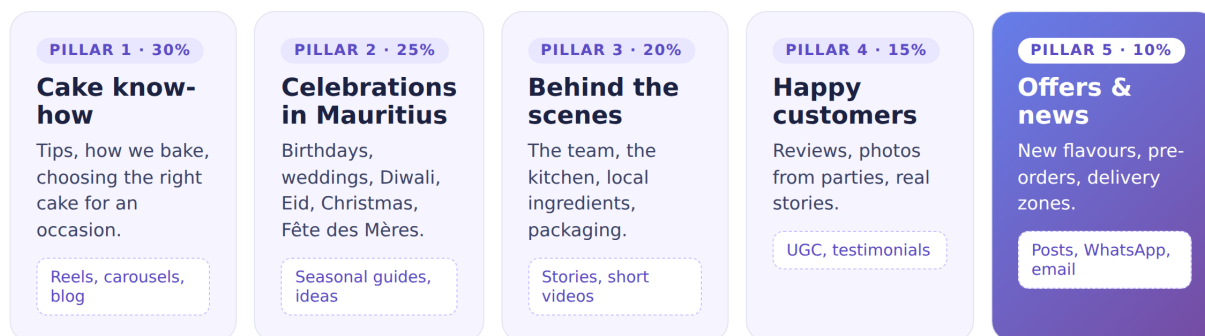
SECTION 9

Content pillars

Content pillars are the 3-5 main themes your brand talks about again and again. They connect what your audience cares about with what your business offers, and they make planning much easier: every idea must fit a pillar.

Content pillars: the 3-5 themes you own

Example: Lakaz Gato, a cake shop in Rose Hill



How to choose your pillars

1. List what your audience cares about (from your persona and their questions).
2. List what your business knows and sells (products, expertise, values, people).
3. Find where the two overlap: those are your pillar candidates.
4. Keep 3-5 pillars, give each a clear name and a target share of your content.
5. Check each pillar can produce at least 10 ideas. If not, it is too narrow.

Pillar examples for Mauritian businesses

Business	Pillars
Guesthouse in the north	Things to do in the north · Life at the guesthouse · Mauritian food and culture · Guest stories · Offers and seasons
Gym in Quatre Bornes	Training tips for beginners · Nutrition with local food · Member transformations · Coaches and classes · Challenges and events
Accounting firm (B2B)	Tax and MRA (Mauritius Revenue Authority) deadlines explained · Starting a business in Mauritius · Finance tips for SMEs · Team and expertise · Client case studies
Hardware store	DIY how-to · Cyclone and rainy-season preparation · Product comparisons · Projects by customers · Promotions
Training company	Skills and career tips · Industry trends · Student success stories · Behind the classroom · Course dates and offers

Turning a pillar into many ideas

Pick a pillar and apply angles: **how to**, **mistakes to avoid**, **myths vs facts**, **before/after**, **behind the scenes**, **FAQ**, **comparison**, **checklist**, **story**, **trend**, **number list** ("5 ways..."), **local angle** ("...in Mauritius"). Five pillars × ten angles = fifty ideas.

SECTION 10

Content types and formats

The same idea can become a photo, a carousel, a reel, an article or an email. Choose the format by the goal, the platform and the effort you can afford.

Format	Best for	Effort	Tips
Short video (Reels, TikTok, Shorts)	Reach, discovery, personality	Medium	Hook in the first 3 seconds, subtitles, vertical 9:16
Carousel (up to 20 slides on Instagram)	Teaching, lists, step-by-step; high saves	Low-medium	Strong first slide, one idea per slide, CTA on the last
Single image post	Announcements, quotes, products	Low	One message; text readable on a phone
Stories	Daily connection, polls, behind-the-scenes, links	Low	Interactive stickers; save the best as Highlights
Live video	Q&A, launches, events, community	Medium	Announce in advance; repurpose the replay
Blog article / guide	Google and AI visibility, expertise, consideration	High	Answer one question well (Week 3 on-page rules)
Long video (YouTube)	Tutorials, reviews, deep trust	High	Clear title with keyword, chapters, thumbnail
Email newsletter	Loyalty, repeat sales, owned audience	Medium	One main message, mobile-friendly (Week 10)
WhatsApp Channel / Status	Updates to people who opted in	Low	Short, useful, not too frequent
Case study / testimonial	Proof at the decision stage	Medium	Real numbers, real names (with permission)
Checklist, template, e-book	Lead generation (email sign-ups)	Medium-high	Truly useful, one page is often enough
Podcast / audio	Thought leadership, niche communities	High	Also publish as video and short clips

Image and video sizes (2026)

Placement	Recommended size	Ratio
Reels, TikTok, Shorts, Stories	1080 × 1920 px	9:16 vertical
Instagram and Facebook feed (portrait)	1080 × 1350 px	4:5
Square post	1080 × 1080 px	1:1
LinkedIn feed image	1200 × 1200 or 1200 × 1500 px	1:1 or 4:5
YouTube video and thumbnail	1920 × 1080 px / 1280 × 720 px	16:9
Website banner	About 1920 × 600-800 px (check your theme)	Wide

Platforms update their specifications regularly; Canva's templates are a quick way to get the current size.

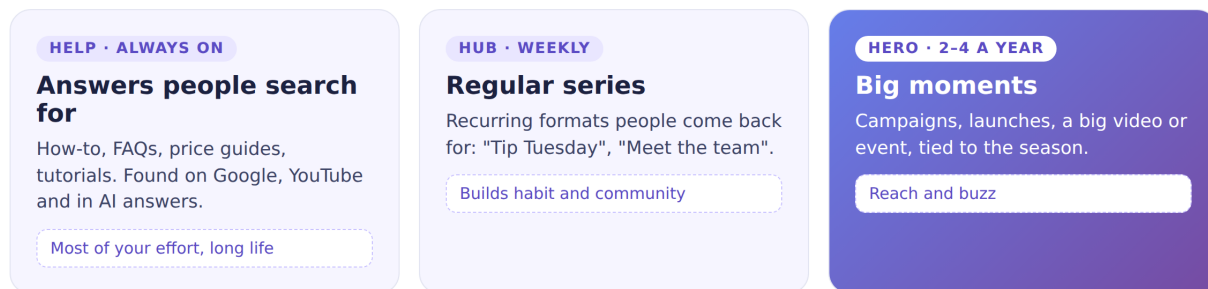
SECTION 11

Getting the mix right

A healthy content mix keeps your audience interested and avoids two traps: selling all the time, or never asking for the sale.

Hero • Hub • Help

A simple way to balance big moments, regular content and answers



Useful mix rules

Rule	How it works	Good for
80/20 rule	80% helpful, entertaining or inspiring content; 20% promotional	Most consumer brands
Rule of thirds	1/3 about your business, 1/3 sharing ideas and news from your industry, 1/3 personal interaction (replies, community)	Personal brands, services
Educate • Entertain • Inspire • Sell	Rotate the four purposes across the week	Social media calendars
Hero • Hub • Help	Big moments a few times a year, weekly series, always-on answers	Brands with video and website content

Don't copy-paste everywhere. The same idea can go on several platforms, but adapt it: vertical video with trending sound for TikTok, a carousel for Instagram, a professional lesson for LinkedIn, a full article for the website.

How often should you post?

Consistency beats volume. A realistic plan you can keep for months is better than a burst of daily posts for two weeks. A practical starting point for a small business:

Channel	Starting frequency
Instagram / Facebook feed	3 posts a week (including 1-2 reels)
Stories	3-5 days a week
TikTok	2-4 short videos a week if it is a priority channel
LinkedIn (company or personal)	2-3 posts a week
Website article or guide	1-2 a month
Email newsletter	1-2 a month
Google Business Profile posts	1 a week (offers, news, events)

PART C

Creation

Storytelling, copywriting,
visuals, video and AI

Storytelling

Facts inform, but stories make people feel, remember and share. Storytelling is not about inventing fiction: it is about presenting real situations in a structure people naturally follow.

A simple story structure that works

Your customer is the hero; your brand is the guide



Make the customer the hero

A common mistake is to make the business the hero ("We are the best, we have 20 years of experience"). Your audience cares about their own story. Position your customer as the hero with a goal and a problem, and your brand as the **guide** who understands them and gives them a plan. Your experience becomes the proof that you are a good guide, not the story itself.

Six stories every business can tell

Story type	What it shows	Example
Origin story	Why you started; your values	How a grandmother's recipe became a cake shop in Rose Hill
Customer success	Proof that you deliver	A guest's honeymoon at the guesthouse, in their own words
Behind the scenes	Craft, care and people	A day in the kitchen before Divali orders
Problem solved	Expertise in action	How we fixed a leaking roof before a cyclone warning
Values and community	What you stand for	Supporting a local school or beach clean-up
Lessons learned	Honesty and expertise (great on LinkedIn)	"3 mistakes we made in our first year"

Storytelling techniques that work on social media

- **Start in the middle of the action:** "It was 6 a.m. and the wedding cake had collapsed." Skip long introductions.
- **Show, don't tell:** instead of "we care about quality", show the baker rejecting a batch of strawberries.
- **Use a real person and specific details:** names (with permission), places, numbers, dialogue.
- **Create a little tension:** a problem, a deadline, a surprise. Then resolve it.

- **Use contrast:** before/after, expectation/reality, myth/fact.
- **End with a takeaway or a call to action** linked to the story.
- **Make series:** recurring characters (the team, a mascot, a "client of the month") make people come back.

In Mauritius: Mauritius has a rich storytelling culture: family recipes, village history, multicultural celebrations, the sea and the land. Local stories told with respect and pride connect deeply, both with Mauritians and with visitors.

SECTION 13

Copywriting: words that make people act

Copywriting is writing that leads to an action: read, watch, click, message, buy. Good copy is clear, specific and focused on the reader.

Four classic formulas

Formula	Structure	Example (caption)
AIDA	Attention → Interest → Desire → Action	"Planning a party for 30? Our 2-tier cakes serve 30–35 people. Choose from 12 flavours, delivered anywhere in Plaines Wilhems. Order on WhatsApp by Thursday for Saturday."
PAS	Problem → Agitation → Solution	"Back pain after long days at the desk? It gets worse when you ignore it. Our 30-minute beginner class strengthens your back 3 times a week. First class free."
BAB	Before → After → Bridge	"Before: 3 hours of Excel every month for VAT. After: 20 minutes. The bridge: our free VAT checklist for SMEs. Link in bio."
FAB	Feature → Advantage → Benefit	"Solar panels with battery (feature) keep power on during cuts (advantage), so your freezer and Wi-Fi keep working in cyclone season (benefit)."

Headlines and hooks

Most people read only the headline, the first line of a caption or the first 3 seconds of a video. Spend real time on it. Good hooks are:

Hook type	Example
Number list	"5 things to check before booking a wedding venue in Mauritius"
Question	"Do you know how much sugar is in your morning alouda?"
Mistake / warning	"Stop storing your rice like this in the rainy season"
Surprising fact	"A 2-minute video can cut your customer questions in half"
Before / after	"This garden cost Rs 8,000 to transform. Here's how."
Direct benefit	"Get your trade licence in 7 days: the complete checklist"
Local curiosity	"The best-kept secret beach in the south (that locals love)"

The 4 U test for headlines

A strong headline is **Useful**, **Urgent** (a reason to read now), **Unique** and **Ultra-specific**. "Tips for your garden" scores low; "3 plants that survive a Mauritian summer with 10 minutes of care a week" scores high.

Calls to action (CTAs)

- **One main action per piece.** Too many choices mean no action.
- **Use a verb and a benefit:** "Send us your date on WhatsApp to check availability", not "Contact us".
- **Match the stage:** "Save this for later" or "Share with a friend" for awareness; "Book a free call" for conversion.
- **Make it easy:** a WhatsApp click-to-chat link, a booking link in bio, a QR code in the shop.
- **Add a reason to act now** when it is true: limited places, a date, a season.

Writing captions that get read

- First line = hook (the rest is hidden behind "more").
- Short sentences and line breaks; a few emojis as signposts, not decoration everywhere.
- Use keywords people search for (Instagram and TikTok are search engines too).
- 3–5 relevant hashtags are enough; mix a local one (#mauritius, #ilemaurice) with topic ones.
- End with a question or CTA to start a conversation, then reply to comments quickly.

SECTION 14

Writing for the web and for search

Content on your website and blog has a long life: it can bring visitors from Google and AI answers for years. It needs to be easy to scan and to answer real questions (Week 3).

How people read online

Online, people scan before they read. They look at headings, bold text and the first words of paragraphs. Write accordingly:

Do	Avoid
Answer the main question in the first 2–3 sentences	Long introductions ("In today's fast-paced world...")
Clear H2 headings, often as questions	Walls of text without structure
Short paragraphs (2–4 lines), bullet points, tables	Jargon and abbreviations nobody explains
Specific facts: prices in rupees, times, places, steps	Vague promises ("best quality", "great service")
Your own photos, examples and experience	Copied supplier text or unchecked AI text
A clear next step at the end (and in the middle for long pages)	Ending without a call to action

A blog article template

1. **Title** with the main keyword and a benefit (50–60 characters).
2. **Introduction:** the problem and a direct answer in 2–3 sentences.
3. **Body:** 3–6 sections with H2 headings; one idea per section; examples and photos.
4. **FAQ** with 3–5 real questions and short answers (great for AEO, Week 3).
5. **Conclusion and CTA:** summary and the next step (book, call, download).

6. **Internal links** to related pages and products; **meta description** and image alt text.

Readability tips

- Aim for sentences of about 15–20 words on average.
- Write as you would explain to a smart friend; read it aloud to check.
- Use "you" and "we"; active voice ("we deliver" rather than "delivery is made").
- For bilingual sites, write each language properly instead of using machine translation without review.

SECTION 15

Visual content with Canva

Canva is the free (with paid options) design tool used by most small businesses to create posts, stories, videos, presentations and printed material. You do not need design training to produce clean, consistent visuals.

Getting started in Canva

1. Create a free account at canva.com (or with the mobile app).
2. Set up your **Brand Kit**: logo, colour codes and fonts (the full Brand Kit is a paid feature; on the free plan, keep your colour codes and fonts in a note and reuse them).
3. Search a template by format ("Instagram post", "Story", "Reel", "LinkedIn post") and adapt it to your brand.
4. Save 4–6 of your own templates for recurring content: tips, quotes, offers, reviews, announcements.
5. Use the content planner or download and schedule with Meta Business Suite.

Five design rules for non-designers

Rule	In practice
Hierarchy	One main element (title or photo) clearly bigger than the rest
Contrast	Dark text on light background or the opposite; test on a phone at low brightness
Space	Leave empty space around text; don't fill every corner
Consistency	Same 2–3 colours, same 1–2 fonts, same logo position
Less text	A post should be understood in 2 seconds; put details in the caption

Photos: your most valuable visual asset

- **Natural light** near a window or outdoors in the shade; avoid harsh midday sun.
- **Clean background**; remove clutter.
- **Shoot vertically** for stories and reels, and leave space for text.
- **Real people and real products** beat stock images. Ask permission before posting people's faces, and keep a record of it.
- **Build a photo bank**: one hour a month photographing products, team, place and process gives you weeks of content.

Canva's AI features (Magic Studio)

Canva includes AI tools to generate images, remove backgrounds, resize designs for other platforms, write first drafts and translate. They save time, but check every output: generated images can look artificial, and translations need a native speaker's review.

Tip: keep text on images large: at least 40–50 px on a 1080 px-wide post. Most people view on a phone.

SECTION 16

Short-form video

Short vertical video (Reels, TikTok, YouTube Shorts) is the main way new people discover brands on social media. You don't need a studio: a recent smartphone, good light and a clear idea are enough.

Anatomy of a short video that gets watched

Reels, TikTok, YouTube Shorts: 15–60 seconds



Video ideas that work for any business

Idea	Example
How it's made / process	Time-lapse of a cake, a dress or a garden from start to finish
Quick tip or tutorial	"How to tie a pareo in 3 ways"
Myth vs fact	"Do you need to warm up your car engine? Mechanic explains"
Day in the life	A morning at the guesthouse, from breakfast to boat trip
Customer reaction	Unboxing or surprise moment (with permission)
FAQ answered	"Do you deliver to Grand Baie?" answered in 15 seconds
Before / after	A room renovation, a haircut, a cleaned car
Trend with a local twist	A popular audio adapted to your business, in Kreol

Simple filming kit and settings

- **Phone** with a clean lens, filming in 1080p or 4K, vertical.
- **Light:** face a window; a small ring light (about Rs 1,000–2,500) helps indoors.
- **Sound:** a clip-on microphone (from about Rs 1,500) makes a big difference for talking videos.
- **Stability:** a small tripod or rest the phone on something stable.
- **Editing:** CapCut, Instagram's Edits app, Canva or the platform's own editor.

Rules for scroll-stopping video

- Show the most interesting moment first; don't start with a logo.
- Put text on screen: most people watch without sound at first.
- Add subtitles (auto-captions) and check spelling.

- Change shot every 2–3 seconds; cut silences.
- Keep it as short as the idea needs: 15–30 seconds for tips, up to 60–90 seconds for stories.
- Use music from the platform’s library to stay within copyright rules (business accounts have a commercial library).
- Write a clear caption with keywords and one CTA.

Faces build trust

Videos with a real person talking to the camera (the owner, a team member, a customer) usually create more trust and comments than product-only videos. Start with short, natural clips; perfection is not required.

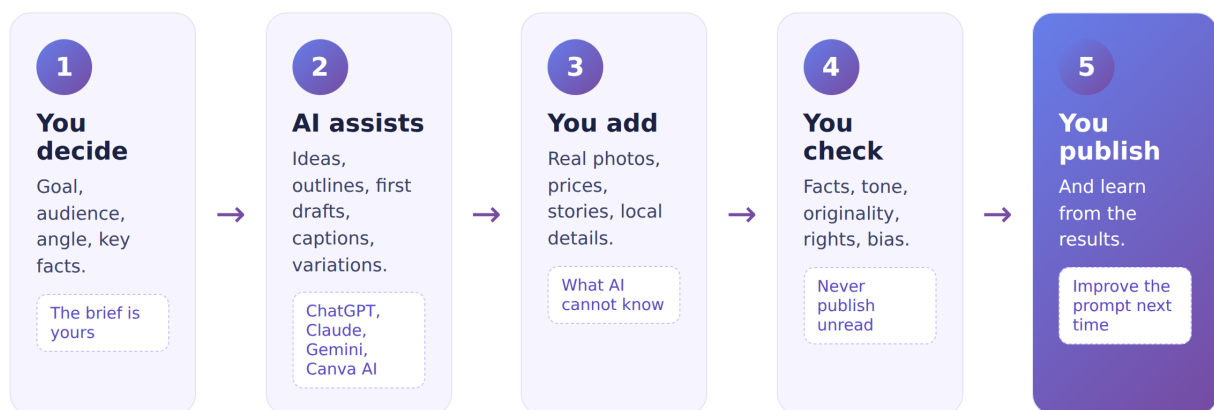
SECTION 17

Using AI for content, responsibly

AI assistants such as ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini, and AI features in Canva and social platforms, can save hours each week. Used badly, they produce generic content that sounds like everyone else. Week 13 goes deeper; here are the basics you need now.

Using AI for content: human in the loop

AI speeds up the work; you bring facts, taste and experience



Where AI helps most

Task	Example prompt
Brainstorm ideas	"Give me 20 content ideas for a cake shop in Rose Hill, Mauritius, for the pillar 'Celebrations in Mauritius', for families with young children."
Outline an article	"Create an outline for a blog post 'How to choose a wedding cake in Mauritius' with H2 headings and an FAQ of 5 questions."
Write variations	"Write 5 hook lines for a reel about keeping fresh-cream cakes cool in summer. Warm, local tone, max 10 words."
Adapt to platforms	"Turn this blog summary into a LinkedIn post, an Instagram caption and a WhatsApp status."
Translate and localise	"Translate this caption into French as spoken in Mauritius; keep it friendly. Flag anything that may not translate well."
Repurpose	"From this 10-minute video transcript, suggest 5 short clips with timestamps and a caption for each."

A simple prompt structure

Give the AI the same information you would give a new team member: **role** (you are a social media copywriter for...), **context** (business, audience, voice, facts), **task** (what to produce), **format** (length, structure, number of options) and **examples** of content you like. The more specific the input, the better the output.

Rules for responsible use

- **Check every fact**, price, date and claim. AI can invent things confidently.
- **Add what AI doesn't know**: your photos, real customer stories, local details, current offers.
- **Keep your voice**: edit the draft until it sounds like you. Give the AI your voice chart (Section 8).
- **Don't paste confidential data** (customer details, private figures) into public AI tools.
- **Respect rights**: don't ask AI to imitate a specific artist's work or copy a competitor's content.
- **Label realistic AI images or videos** where platforms require it (Meta, TikTok and YouTube have AI-content labels), and never use AI to fake testimonials or reviews.

Google does not penalise content just because AI helped write it, but mass-produced pages with little value can lose visibility. What matters is that content is helpful, accurate and shows real experience.

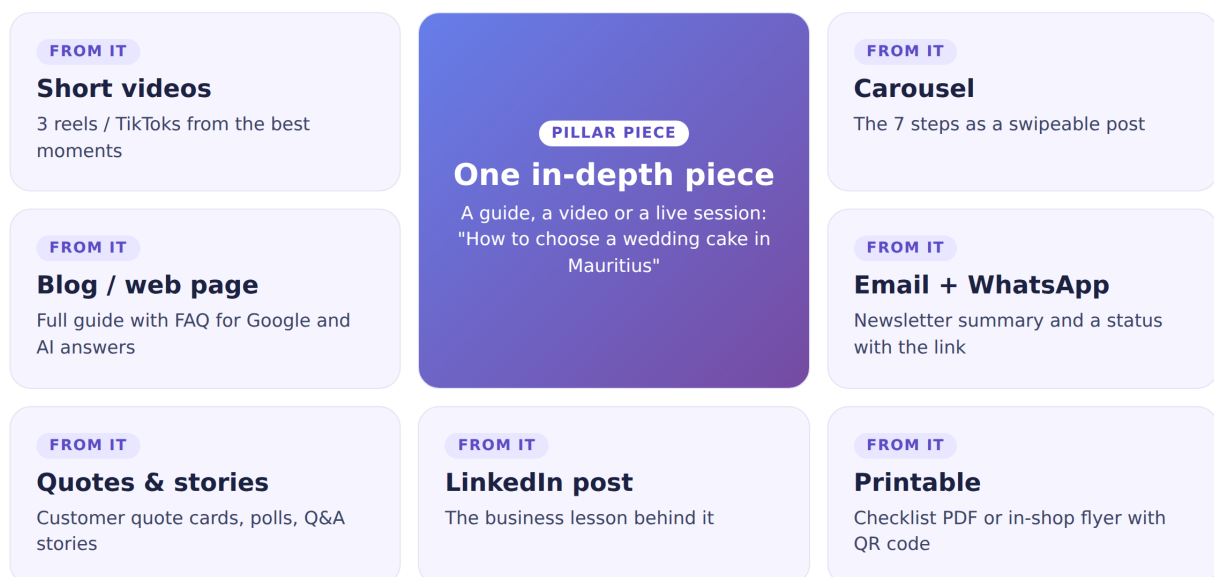
SECTION 18

Repurposing: create once, publish many times

The most efficient content teams don't create every post from scratch. They produce one strong "pillar piece" and turn it into many smaller pieces for different channels.

Create once, publish ten times

Repurposing one strong idea across formats and channels



How to repurpose in practice

1. **Pick one pillar piece per month:** a guide, a live session, a webinar, an interview or a long video.
2. **Extract the key ideas:** list 5–10 tips, quotes, statistics or moments.
3. **Map each idea to a format and channel** (reel, carousel, story, email, LinkedIn post).
4. **Adapt, don't copy:** change the hook, the length and the CTA for each platform.
5. **Schedule across 3–4 weeks** so the topic gets repeated exposure.
6. **Recycle evergreen content:** republish your best-performing posts every few months with a fresh hook.

Tip: keep a simple "content bank" (a spreadsheet or Notion database) with every piece, its pillar, format, link and results. Before creating something new, check what you can reuse.

Evergreen vs topical content

Evergreen content stays useful for months or years ("How to prepare your house for cyclone season"). **Topical** content is tied to a moment (a trend, a news item, a festival). A good calendar mixes both: evergreen content builds long-term traffic, topical content brings spikes of attention.

PART D

Planning & distribution

Calendars, workflow, channels,
creators and community

SECTION 19

The editorial calendar

An editorial (content) calendar is the schedule of what you will publish, where and when. It turns your strategy into daily action, helps you prepare for key dates and makes it easy to see gaps and repetitions.

What to include in the calendar

Column	Example
Date and time	Tue 4 Nov, 18:30
Channel	Instagram + Facebook
Pillar	Celebrations in Mauritius
Stage / goal	Consideration
Format	Carousel, 7 slides
Topic and hook	"Divali sweets box: how many pieces per guest?"
CTA	Pre-order on WhatsApp
Owner and status	Anjali · idea / draft / approved / scheduled / published
Link and results	Post link; reach, saves, shares, enquiries (filled later)

Build an 8-week calendar in 6 steps

1. **Mark the fixed dates** for the 8 weeks: festivals, public holidays, school holidays, launches, events, paydays.
2. **Decide the weekly rhythm**: for example Monday tip (Help), Wednesday reel (Hub series), Friday offer or review (Sell), plus stories.
3. **Assign pillars** to the slots so each pillar gets its target share over the month.
4. **Plan one pillar piece per month** (a guide, live or long video) and the pieces you will repurpose from it.
5. **Fill topics and hooks** from your idea list (customer questions, competitor gaps, seasonal ideas).
6. **Leave about 20% free** for reactive content: trends, news, customer moments.

Example: two weeks for a cake shop

Day	Channel	Pillar	Format	Topic / hook	CTA
Mon W1	IG + FB	Cake know-how	Carousel	"How many people does a 2 kg cake feed?"	Save it
Wed W1	IG + TikTok	Behind the scenes	Reel	"6 a.m. at Lakaz Gato: 40 Divali orders"	Follow
Thu W1	Google Business Profile	Offers	Post	Divali sweets boxes now available	Order
Fri W1	IG + FB	Happy customers	Photo + review	Priya's mother's 60th, in her words	Message us
Tue W2	Website + Email	Celebrations	Guide	"Divali sweets: a guide to ordering for your family"	Pre-order
Wed W2	IG + TikTok	Cake know-how	Reel	"3 mistakes when storing fresh cream cakes"	Share
Fri W2	WhatsApp Channel	Offers	Status + link	Last day for Divali pre-orders	Order now
Sat W2	IG Stories	Behind the scenes	Poll	"Which flavour should we launch next?"	Vote

Tools for your calendar

A shared Google Sheet or Notion database is enough to start. Meta Business Suite (free) schedules Facebook and Instagram posts; LinkedIn and TikTok let you schedule natively; Buffer and Hootsuite have free or low-cost plans for several platforms. Canva also has a content planner.

Tip: the best time to post is when your audience is online. Check your Meta and LinkedIn insights. Many Mauritian audiences are active early morning, at lunchtime and in the evening (about 19:00–21:30), but test your own data.

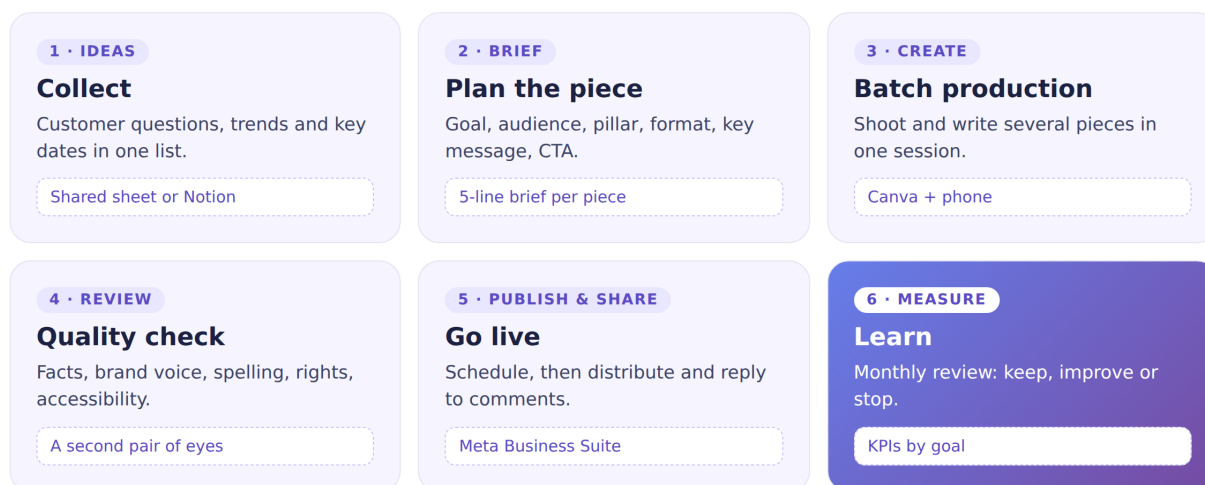
SECTION 20

Workflow, roles and production

Consistency comes from a process, not from motivation. A simple workflow lets a small team (or one person) produce good content every week without last-minute stress.

From idea to published: a content workflow

A repeatable process saves time and keeps quality high



The content brief

Every important piece starts with a short brief. It takes 5 minutes and saves hours of rework, whether you write the content yourself, give it to a designer or ask an AI tool.

Brief field	Example
Goal	Get Divali pre-orders (conversion)
Audience	Families in Plaines Wilhems, 25–50
Pillar and format	Celebrations · Carousel, 7 slides
Key message	Order your sweets box by 28 Oct, delivered on the morning of Divali
Proof	3 customer reviews, photos of last year's boxes
CTA	Pre-order on WhatsApp (link)
Deadline and owner	Draft Wed 15 Oct · Anjali

Roles, even in a small team

Role	Responsibility	Small-business reality
Strategist / owner	Goals, pillars, calendar, approval	Often the business owner
Creator	Photos, videos, design, writing	A team member, a freelancer or yourself with Canva
Community manager	Replies to comments and messages, monitors mentions	Must be fast: the same day, ideally within hours
Analyst	Monthly results and recommendations	Can be the owner with a 1-hour monthly review

Batching: the time-saver

Instead of creating one post a day, group similar tasks: one session to plan the month, one half-day to shoot all photos and videos, one session to design and write captions, then schedule everything. Batching can cut production time by half and keeps the style consistent.

Quality checklist before publishing

- ☐ Fits a pillar and the goal; one clear message and CTA
- ☐ Facts, prices, dates and spelling checked (in every language)
- ☐ Brand colours, fonts and voice respected
- ☐ Rights cleared: own photos/music or licensed; permission from people shown
- ☐ Readable on a phone; subtitles on video; alt text where possible
- ☐ Links and WhatsApp numbers tested; UTM tags on website links (Week 2)

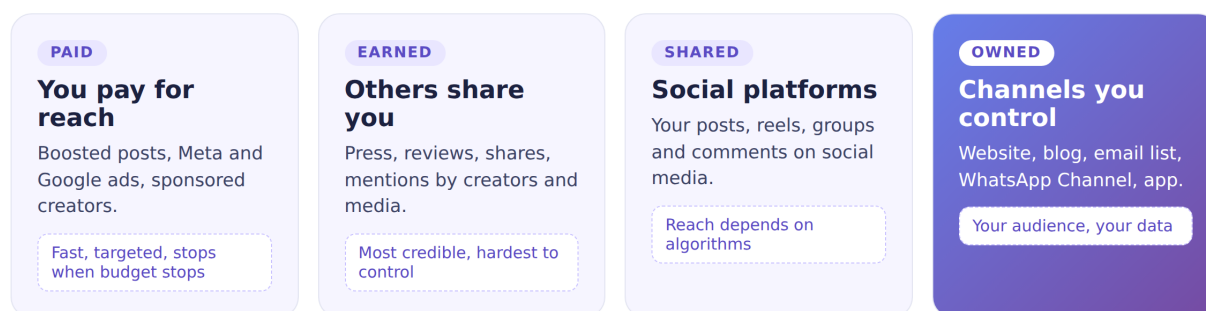
SECTION 21

Distribution: getting content seen

Creating content is only half the job. Without a distribution plan, even excellent content reaches very few people. A common guideline is to spend as much effort sharing and promoting content as creating it.

The PESO model: four ways to distribute content

The strongest plans combine all four



Owned channels first

Your website, email list and WhatsApp Channel are channels you control. Social media platforms can change their algorithm or close an account overnight. Always use social content to bring people back to owned channels: a link to the full guide, a newsletter sign-up, a WhatsApp opt-in.

A distribution checklist for every important piece

- ☐ Publish on the main channel at the best time
- ☐ Adapt and share on 2–3 other platforms (different format, hook and CTA)
- ☐ Share in Stories and WhatsApp Status; pin important posts
- ☐ Send to your email list or WhatsApp Channel when it is valuable
- ☐ Post on Google Business Profile (offers, events, updates)
- ☐ Ask the team to share; tag partners and featured people (with permission)
- ☐ Share in relevant groups where it is allowed and genuinely useful (no spam)
- ☐ Reply to every comment in the first hour: it signals interest to the algorithm
- ☐ Boost the best organic posts with a small budget (Weeks 6–9)
- ☐ Link it from related pages on your website (internal links, Week 3)

Paid promotion of content

A simple, effective approach for small budgets: let content run organically for 2–3 days, then put a small budget (for example Rs 1,000–3,000) behind the posts that already perform best. You will learn to do this properly in Week 8 (Meta Ads).

SECTION 22

Platform playbooks

Each platform has its own culture, formats and algorithm. Here is what to focus on for the main channels used in Mauritius.

Platform	What the algorithm rewards	Content that works	Watch out
Facebook	Meaningful interactions, shares, comments, watch time on video	Community posts, local news, events, reels, groups, albums	Organic reach of pages is low; groups and video help
Instagram	Shares (sends), saves, watch time; original content	Reels, carousels (up to 20 slides), stories, collaborations	Reposts and watermarked videos are shown less
TikTok	Completion rate, rewatches, shares; interest-based discovery	Entertaining and educational short video, trends with a twist	Very fast trends; post consistently; keep it authentic
LinkedIn	Dwell time, comments from relevant people, expertise	Personal posts with lessons, documents (PDF carousels), short videos, polls	Company pages reach less than people: involve the team
YouTube	Watch time, click-through on thumbnails, satisfaction	Tutorials, reviews, vlogs; Shorts for discovery	Titles and thumbnails are critical
WhatsApp	No algorithm: people chose to receive you	Channel updates, Status, broadcast lists, catalogue (WhatsApp Business)	Only message people who opted in; don't spam
Google Business Profile	Completeness, activity, reviews	Weekly posts, offers, events, photos, Q&A	Posts are short; keep the information accurate
Website / blog	Helpful, people-first content (Week 3)	Guides, FAQs, case studies, price pages	Needs time to rank; update regularly

WhatsApp for business content

- **WhatsApp Business app** (free): business profile, catalogue, quick replies, labels and away messages.
- **Channels:** one-way updates that people choose to follow. Good for news, offers and tips.
- **Status:** 24-hour stories seen by your contacts. Ideal for daily specials or behind-the-scenes.
- **Broadcast lists:** send one message to many contacts; only people who saved your number receive it.
- **Click-to-chat link:** wa.me/230XXXXXXXXX opens a chat with you. Use it in bios, posts and QR codes.

LinkedIn for B2B and personal brands

With about 630,000 members in Mauritius and fast growth, LinkedIn is the key content platform for B2B services, training, recruitment and consulting. Posts from real people (founders, experts, employees) usually reach far more than company pages. Week 19 covers personal branding in depth.

SECTION 23

Creators, user-generated content and community

People trust other people more than brands. Working with creators, encouraging customers to share and building a community multiplies your content and your credibility.

User-generated content (UGC)

UGC is content created by your customers: photos, videos, reviews, stories that mention you. It is free, authentic and convincing.

- **Ask for it:** a card in the package or a message after delivery: "Share a photo and tag us".
- **Make it easy:** a branded hashtag, a photo corner in the shop, a moment worth filming.
- **Celebrate it:** repost (with permission and credit), "customer of the month", small rewards.
- **Collect reviews** on Google (Week 3) and use the best ones in your content.

Working with creators and influencers

Type	Followers (approx.)	Why work with them
Nano	Under 10,000	Very close, trusted communities; affordable; often local
Micro	10,000–50,000	Good engagement and niche credibility (food, fitness, travel, parenting)
Mid / macro	50,000+	Reach and visibility; higher cost; check that the audience is in Mauritius

How to choose and brief a creator

1. Check fit with your brand and audience (location, age, interests), not just follower numbers.
2. Look at engagement quality: real comments and conversations, not only likes.
3. Ask for audience statistics (screenshots of insights).
4. Agree in writing: deliverables, dates, usage rights (can you reuse the content in ads?), payment or product exchange.
5. Give a brief with key messages and facts, but let them keep their own style.
6. Measure with a unique code or link (UTM, Week 2).

Always disclose partnerships. Paid or gifted content must be clearly labelled (for example with the platform's "Paid partnership" label, or #ad / #sponsored). Hidden advertising misleads consumers, breaks platform rules and damages trust.

Build a community, not just an audience

- Reply to every comment and message, quickly and personally.
- Ask questions, run polls, invite opinions and ideas for new products.

- Create a Facebook or WhatsApp group around a shared interest (e.g. a running club, a parenting community).
- Feature your community: share their content, answer their questions publicly.
- Organise offline moments: workshops, tastings, meet-ups. They create great content too.

SECTION 24

Content, SEO and AI answers

Week 3 showed how Google, AI Overviews and assistants like ChatGPT choose what to show. Your content strategy and your SEO strategy should be the same plan.

SEO / AEO / GEO principle (Week 3)	What it means for your content plan
Keyword research and intent	Turn real search questions into blog posts, videos and FAQ answers
One page, one main topic	Plan one strong page per important question instead of many thin posts
Topic clusters	Use your pillars as clusters: a pillar guide plus supporting articles that link together
Answer-first writing	Start with the direct answer; use question headings; add specific facts
E-E-A-T (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust)	Show real experience: your photos, your team, case studies, author bios
Freshness	Update your best guides every year (prices, dates, rules)
Mentions and links	Useful content earns links and mentions from media and partners

Social search

Many people, especially under 30, search directly on TikTok, Instagram and YouTube ("best brunch Grand Baie", "how to tie a sari"). Use the words people search in your on-screen text, captions, titles and alt text, and answer clear questions in your videos.

PART E

Measure & improve

KPIs, analysis, legal basics
and ethics

Measuring content: KPIs by goal

Measure what matches your goal. Likes feel good but rarely pay the bills. Choose 3-5 KPIs that show whether content moves people through the journey.

Goal	KPIs	Where to find them
Awareness	Reach, impressions, video views, new followers, share of voice	Meta Business Suite, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube analytics
Engagement / interest	Engagement rate, saves, shares, comments, average watch time	Platform analytics
Traffic	Link clicks, sessions from social and email, engaged sessions	Platform analytics, GA4 with UTMs (Week 2)
Leads	WhatsApp clicks, form submissions, email sign-ups, calls	GA4 key events, WhatsApp Business, CRM
Sales	Orders, bookings, revenue attributed to content	GA4, shop system, discount codes
Loyalty	Repeat purchases, email open and click rates, reviews	Email tool, CRM, Google Business Profile

Key formulas

Metric	Formula	Example
Engagement rate (by reach)	$(\text{likes} + \text{comments} + \text{shares} + \text{saves}) \div \text{reach} \times 100$	$(180 + 25 + 40 + 55) \div 6,000 \times 100 = 5\%$
Share rate	$\text{shares} \div \text{reach} \times 100$	$40 \div 6,000 \times 100 = 0.67\%$
Save rate	$\text{saves} \div \text{reach} \times 100$	$55 \div 6,000 \times 100 = 0.92\%$
Click-through rate (CTR)	$\text{link clicks} \div \text{impressions} \times 100$	$90 \div 9,000 \times 100 = 1\%$
Video completion rate	$\text{people who watched to the end} \div \text{people who started} \times 100$	$1,200 \div 8,000 \times 100 = 15\%$
Follower growth rate	$\text{new followers in period} \div \text{followers at start} \times 100$	$150 \div 3,000 \times 100 = 5\%$
Cost per result (if boosted)	$\text{amount spent} \div \text{results}$	$\text{Rs } 2,000 \div 40 \text{ enquiries} = \text{Rs } 50 \text{ per enquiry}$

Platforms calculate engagement in different ways (by reach, by impressions or by followers). Choose one method and keep it, so you compare like with like.

Tip: track enquiries from content: ask every new customer "How did you hear about us?" and note the answer. It is free and very revealing.

Analyse, learn and improve

Content marketing improves through small experiments. A monthly review turns data into decisions.

A monthly content review (1 hour)

1. **Export results** for the month from each platform and GA4.
2. **Compare with last month** and with your objectives.
3. **Rank your top 5 and bottom 5 pieces.** What do the top ones have in common (pillar, format, hook, time, person on camera)?
4. **Check the funnel:** did content bring clicks, enquiries and sales, or only likes?
5. **Read the comments and messages:** new questions = new content ideas.
6. **Decide 3 actions:** do more of X, improve Y, stop Z. Update the calendar.

Simple tests to run

Test	Compare	Measure
Hook	Two different first lines or first seconds on similar content	Average watch time, reach
Format	Same idea as a carousel vs a reel	Saves, shares, reach
Time	Morning vs evening posting for 4 weeks	Reach and engagement
Face vs product	Person talking vs product-only video	Watch time, comments, enquiries
CTA	"Message us" vs "Book on the website"	Clicks and conversions

Instagram's Trial Reels feature lets you test a reel with non-followers first before showing it to your own audience. A good way to test ideas safely.

Change one thing at a time and give each test enough time (at least 2-4 weeks or several posts). One post is not a trend.

Legal and ethical basics

Content creates trust only if it is honest and respects other people's rights. These basics protect your business. This is general information, not legal advice; for specific cases consult a professional.

Topic	The basics
Copyright	Photos, music, videos, fonts and texts belong to their creators. Use your own, licensed or free-to-use material (check the licence). "Found on Google" does not mean free to use.
Music on social media	Use the platform's music library for business accounts. Popular songs added in your own editing can get videos muted or removed.
People's images	Ask permission before posting identifiable people, especially customers, staff and children; keep written consent for ads and testimonials.
Personal data	Mauritius' Data Protection Act 2017 protects personal data. Collect contacts with consent, explain how you use them, and let people unsubscribe.
Honest claims	Don't exaggerate or invent results, reviews or testimonials. Prices and conditions must be clear.
Disclosure	Label paid partnerships, gifted products and affiliate links.
AI content	Label realistic AI-generated images or videos where platforms require it; never fake real people, reviews or events.
Respect and inclusion	Avoid stereotypes; check cultural and religious details; be careful with humour on sensitive topics.

In Mauritius: the Data Protection Office (dataprotection.govmu.org) publishes guidance for organisations. If you collect emails or phone numbers for marketing, keep proof of consent and an easy way to opt out (Week 10 covers email marketing rules).

PART F

Put it to work

A case study, exercises,
templates and checklists

Case study: 8 weeks of content for a guesthouse

A fictional but realistic example that brings the whole method together. "Lagon Bleu" is a 9-room family guesthouse in Trou aux Biches (the same business used in the Week 3 SEO guide). Most bookings come through Booking.com, which takes a commission. The owners want more direct bookings.

1. Goal and objective

Business goal: more direct bookings to reduce commission costs. **SMART content objective:** in 8 weeks, grow website sessions from social and email by 40%, collect 200 email sign-ups and generate 25 direct-booking enquiries (WhatsApp or website form).

2. Audiences

Persona	Profile	Key questions
Réunion families	Parents 30–45 from Réunion island, French-speaking, school holidays	"Is the beach safe for kids?", "Family room with kitchen?", "How far is the airport?"
European couples	French and German couples 40–65, winter sun, 10–14 nights	"What can we do in the north?", "Is it quiet?", "Good restaurants nearby?"
Local weekenders	Mauritian couples and families, weekend escapes	"Weekend package price?", "Is breakfast included?", "Pool?"

3. Positioning and voice

A calm, family-run guesthouse 2 minutes from the beach, where guests are welcomed like friends and get honest local tips. Voice: warm, local, honest, helpful. Languages: French first, English second, German on the website.

4. Pillars

Pillar	Share	Examples
The north like a local	35%	Snorkelling spots, rainy-day ideas, markets, where to eat dhol puri
Life at Lagon Bleu	25%	Breakfast, rooms, garden, the team, morning routine
Guest stories	20%	Reviews, family holidays, honeymoon moments (with permission)
Plan your stay	20%	Airport transfer, prices, best season, packing list, direct-booking benefits

5. Weekly rhythm

Day	Content	Channels
Monday	Local tip carousel (pillar 1)	Instagram, Facebook
Wednesday	Reel: life at the guesthouse or a local spot	Instagram, Facebook, TikTok
Friday	Guest story or review	Instagram, Facebook, Google Business Profile
Daily	Stories: breakfast, weather, sunset, polls	Instagram, WhatsApp Status
Every 2 weeks	Website guide + newsletter	Website, email
Monthly	Live Q&A "Ask us anything about the north"	Facebook, Instagram

6. Pillar pieces and repurposing

Month 1: "The family guide to Trou aux Biches" (website guide with a free PDF checklist in exchange for an email). From it: 3 reels (best beach for kids, 3 rainy-day ideas, the airport transfer explained), 2 carousels, 1 newsletter, 4 stories. Month 2: "10 places to eat in the north like a local" with the same repurposing pattern.

7. Distribution

- Every reel and carousel ends with "Full guide on our website" and the link in bio (with UTM tags).
- The free PDF checklist is promoted to past guests by email and boosted with Rs 3,000 to Réunion families.
- Guests are invited at check-out to share photos with #LagonBleuMoments; the best are reposted with permission.
- Partnership with a local snorkelling guide: one joint reel a month, both accounts.

8. Results after 8 weeks (illustrative)

KPI	Target	Result	Insight
Website sessions from social and email	+40%	+52%	Guides with practical info get the most clicks
Email sign-ups	200	236	The PDF checklist converts well; boosting helped
Direct-booking enquiries	25	21	Need a clearer "book direct" offer on posts
Best format	-	Reels with the owner talking	3× the watch time of scenery-only reels
Best pillar	-	The north like a local	Most saves and shares

Next actions: add a direct-booking benefit (free airport transfer for 7+ nights) to every Friday post, more owner-led reels, and translate the top guide into German.

The lesson: the guesthouse didn't post more; it posted with a purpose. Every piece answered a real question, fitted a pillar and led people to an owned channel.

Exercises and deliverable

These exercises build your Week 4 deliverable: a content strategy document with an 8-week calendar and 3 sample pieces. Work on a real business: your own, your employer's or one you know well.

Exercise A • Content audit (45 min)

Take the business's last 20–30 posts on its main platform. In a spreadsheet, note for each: date, format, topic, pillar (if any), stage of the journey, reach and engagement. Write 3 conclusions: what works, what doesn't, what is missing.

Exercise B • Persona and 20 questions (30 min)

Complete one persona using the template in Section 6. List 20 questions this persona asks before buying, grouped by stage of the journey.

Exercise C • Pillars and voice (30 min)

Define 3–5 content pillars with their share of content and 5 ideas each. Write a positioning statement and a 4-trait voice chart (Section 8).

Exercise D • 8-week content calendar (60 min)

Build an 8-week calendar in a Google Sheet with the columns from Section 19: date, channel, pillar, stage, format, topic and hook, CTA, owner. Include key Mauritian dates, at least 1 short video a week and 1 pillar piece a month.

Exercise E • Three sample pieces (90 min)

Create 3 real pieces from your calendar, ready to publish: **(1)** a carousel or post designed in Canva, **(2)** a short video script or video (hook, value, CTA), **(3)** a website article of 500–800 words or a newsletter. Each with its caption, CTA and the KPI you would track.

Deliverable: your content strategy document

Part	What to include
1. Business and goal	Business summary, main goal, 1–2 SMART content objectives
2. Audience	1–2 personas and their top questions
3. Audit summary	Current content, competitors, SWOT (half a page)
4. Positioning and voice	Positioning statement, voice chart, visual identity
5. Content pillars	3–5 pillars with share and example ideas
6. Formats and channels	Which formats on which channels and how often
7. Distribution plan	Owned, shared, earned, paid; repurposing plan
8. 8-week calendar	Link to your Google Sheet
9. Three sample pieces	Images, script or video, article or email
10. Measurement	KPIs per objective, tools, monthly review routine

Submit the document (Google Doc or PDF link) and your calendar on the learning platform, Module 4 exercises. Length: 5–8 pages plus the calendar.

Copy-and-use templates

Content brief

Field	Your answer
Title / working idea	
Goal and stage of the journey	
Audience (persona)	
Pillar	
Format and channel(s)	
Key message (one sentence)	
Hook (first line / first 3 seconds)	
Proof (facts, reviews, examples)	
CTA and link (with UTM)	
KPI to track	
Owner and deadline	

Short video script

Part	Seconds	What we see	What we hear / text on screen
Hook	0-3		
Promise	3-6		
Value 1	6-15		
Value 2	15-25		
Value 3	25-35		
CTA	last 3		

Monthly content report

Section	Content
1. Headline	One sentence: what worked, what didn't, why
2. Numbers	Reach, engagement rate, saves/shares, clicks, enquiries, sales vs last month and target
3. Top 3 pieces	Why they worked
4. Bottom 3 pieces	What we learned
5. Next month	3 actions, owner, deadline; calendar changes

Checklists and glossary

Content strategy checklist

- ☐ SMART content objective linked to a business goal
- ☐ 1-3 personas based on real customer insight and questions
- ☐ Content and competitor audit done; gaps identified
- ☐ Positioning statement and voice chart written
- ☐ 3-5 pillars with target share
- ☐ Formats and channels chosen; realistic frequency
- ☐ 8-week calendar with key Mauritian dates and 20% free slots
- ☐ Brief template, workflow and roles agreed
- ☐ Distribution checklist used for every important piece
- ☐ KPIs per goal, UTM links and a monthly review in the diary

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Posting only offers	Follow a mix rule (80/20) and answer real questions
Posting without a goal	Link every piece to a pillar, a stage and a KPI
Trying to be on every platform	Do 2-3 channels well
Inconsistent posting	Plan, batch and schedule; choose a frequency you can keep
Generic stock photos and unchecked AI text	Real photos, real people, edited and fact-checked copy
Ignoring comments and messages	Reply fast; conversations build trust and reach
Measuring only likes	Track saves, shares, clicks, enquiries and sales
Copy-pasting the same post everywhere	Adapt format, hook and CTA to each platform
Using music or images without rights	Use licensed or platform libraries; get permission

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Content marketing	Creating and sharing valuable content to attract, engage and convert an audience
Content strategy	The plan: why, for whom, what, where, how often and how it is measured
Content pillar	One of the 3-5 main themes a brand regularly talks about
Editorial calendar	The schedule of content: dates, channels, topics, formats, owners
Persona	A profile of a typical customer based on research
Brand voice / tone	The brand's consistent personality / how it adapts to each situation
Hook	The first line or first seconds that make people stop and pay attention
CTA	Call to action: the one thing you ask the audience to do next
Evergreen content	Content that stays useful for a long time
Pillar piece	A substantial piece of content that is repurposed into many smaller pieces
Repurposing	Turning one piece into several formats for different channels
UGC	User-generated content: content created by customers or fans
PESO	Paid, Earned, Shared, Owned: the four types of media for distribution
Hero / Hub / Help	Big moments / regular series / always-on helpful content
AIDA, PAS, BAB	Copywriting formulas (Attention-Interest-Desire-Action; Problem-Agitation-Solution; Before-After-Bridge)
Engagement rate	Interactions divided by reach (or impressions), as a percentage
Reach / impressions	Number of people who saw the content / number of times it was displayed
Batching	Producing several pieces of the same type in one session
Brief	A short document describing the goal, audience, message and format of a piece
Trial Reels	Instagram feature to test a reel with non-followers before showing it to followers